A SUMMARY OF THE ENTIRE HILCHOT SHABBAT IN 14 CLASSES

Wine, Beer, Whisky and Spices: Kiddush, Shabbat Meals and Havdala

Class 2 of 14

Series: Laws of Shabbat — a 14-part course

Shiur: 2 of 14

Topic: Wine, Beer, Whisky and Spices — Kiddush, the Shabbat Meals and Havdala

Recorded: Tiferet Eyal, Hendon — 23 October 2018

Schedule note: No shiur the following week (half-term); the series resumed on 6 November.

Recap

Last week we introduced Shabbat's two elements — **Zachor** (the positive: honouring and enjoying the day) and **Shamor** (refraining from melacha) — and the importance of making Shabbat distinct from the six other days. The primary way we fulfil **Zachor** is **Kiddush**.

Part A — Kiddush

A biblical mitzvah, said over wine

Reciting the text of Kiddush on Friday night fulfils the Torah mitzvah of **זָכוֹר אֶת יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת לְקַדְּשׁוֹ**. The act of remembering is the *text itself*. Chazal added that it be said **over a cup of wine**, for two reasons:

1. **To mark the night as different** — we eat a meal every night; beginning this one with Kiddush over wine sets Friday night apart.
2. **Zechirah is linked to wine** — **נַזְכִּירָה דֹדֶיךָ מִיַּיִן** (Shir HaShirim 1:4), *"we will recall your love more than wine."*

Make Kiddush promptly

The Shulchan Aruch rules that on coming home one should **hasten to make Kiddush** — we are to remember Shabbat as soon as it begins. Very relevant once the clocks go back: in midwinter Shabbat comes in around 3:30 pm and people may be home from shul at 4:30 yet wait until 6:30 or 7 to make Kiddush. If one genuinely cannot eat yet, waiting is fine — but where possible, make Kiddush early.

Women are equally obligated

Normally women are exempt from **positive, time-bound mitzvot** — and Kiddush is both. Yet because **זכור ושמור בדבור אחד נאמרו**, whoever is bound by the prohibitions of Shabbat (Shamor)

is equally bound by its positive mitzvot (Zachor). So a woman's obligation in Kiddush is **identical** to a man's — and therefore:

- A husband who would rather not drink wine or grape juice that night may **hear Kiddush from his wife** without any problem.
- **Kol isha:** Chacham Ovadia Yosef rules that *chanting* the Kiddush is not singing — just as a woman may read the Megillah to its cantillation.

How much must be drunk?

The minimum is **מְלֹא לֻגְמָיו** — a **cheekful**, roughly **40–45 ml** (about a quarter of a standard 200 ml plastic cup).

A common, awkward case: you are a guest, and the host takes only a sip. Do you need your own Kiddush?

- The Shulchan Aruch cites the view that it suffices if **anyone at the table** — man or woman — drinks a cheekful. Ideally the one making Kiddush drinks it; if not, try to drink a cheekful yourself (if you won't seem greedy!).
- In real difficulty only: a view that it suffices if a cheekful is drunk **between everyone combined**.
- If **nobody** drinks the required amount, the Kiddush is **void** and must be said again.

Listeners don't have to drink

A common misconception. One who **hears Kiddush and answers Amen** has fulfilled the obligation and may eat — strictly, there is no need to taste the wine. Tasting is **mitzvah min hamuvchar** (praiseworthy), hence the custom to share it. At a crowded kiddush where you cannot reach the grape juice, you need not stand waiting — you may eat.

Distributing the wine — *kos pagum*

Wine already used for a mitzvah and drunk from is "blemished" (**pagum**) once transferred elsewhere, so pouring from the Kiddush cup into everyone's glasses after drinking is not correct. Three equally good options:

1. **Pass the cup around** — everyone drinks from the same cup (simplest, least hygienic). It remains fit while in the same cup.
2. **Rectify the cup** — after drinking, add a significant amount of fresh wine to the cup, then pour out to others.
3. **Pour first** — pour into others' cups *before* drinking yourself. This is part of the mitzvah, so it is no interruption (*hefsek*) between bracha and drinking.

Also fine: each guest has a **pre-poured glass** before Kiddush — you need not drink from the Kiddush cup itself, at home or in shul.

Wine or grape juice? Red or white?

- Any wine may be used if fresh and without a bad smell.
- The **Rambam** disqualifies wine that has been processed — sweetened or **yayin mevushal** (pasteurised). Most Rishonim, and the Shulchan Aruch, permit it — but out of respect for the Rambam, **if equally enjoyable, prefer non-mevushal wine**.

- If the wine available is **mevushal anyway**, wine and grape juice are **equally good**.
- **Red is preferred over white** — some opinions require it to look like wine as well as taste like it. White is acceptable if there is no red.

No wine or grape juice?

The Rabbi asked the room — and **Adrian** gave the right answer: *it depends when.*

When	What to use	Why
Friday night	Kiddush on the *challah*: wash, then say the full Kiddush with *Hamotzi* in place of *Hagafen*	The long bracha *Mekadesh HaShabbat* makes it clearly distinct from any other meal
Shabbat morning	*Chamar medina* — the alcoholic drink of the country (in England: whisky, beer)	Morning Kiddush is just *Borei Pri HaGafen*; over bread it would look like an ordinary weekday meal
Shabbat morning, nothing at all	Bread	Kiddush belongs with a meal
Havdala	Wine, or *chamar medina* — **never bread**	Havdala is not tied to a meal

We hold *chamar medina* must be **alcoholic** — not tea or Coca-Cola (some Ashkenazim are more lenient).

Question: For Kiddush on challah on Friday night, do you wash first? — **Yes**, wash, then say Kiddush over the challah.

Part B — The Shabbat Meals (Se'udot Shabbat)

Why three meals?

Chazal obligated **three meals** so that we actually **enjoy Shabbat**. Like booking an appointment with yourself or your family — without putting it in the diary, the break never happens; even on Shabbat one can get carried away and forget to enjoy it. The obligation can only be understood in that context: Chazal want us to be **me'aneg et haShabbat**.

With bread

All three meals should include **bread** — even a lavish gourmet meal without bread does not fulfil the institution. Two reasons:

1. The source of three meals is the **manna**, which the Torah calls *lechem*.
2. A meal with bread has **kevi'ut** — formality and importance: you wash, sit down, and gather.

When you're not obliged to eat

Because the meals exist for enjoyment, one who will **not** enjoy them need not force himself:

- A **medical condition** (e.g. cannot tolerate gluten or wheat).

- Someone who knows he will feel **bloated and uncomfortable**.
- **Rav Shlomo Zalman Auerbach**: even one merely uneasy that eating will harm his weight or health is not obligated.

But if one can eat a **kezayit** of bread (just under 30 g) without discomfort, one should.

Diets

- **A diet for health** — a strong case for exemption if the meals would undermine it. The Shulchan Aruch speaks of someone who fasts every day: he need not eat on Shabbat, as it would disrupt his routine.
- **A diet only to be thinner**, not for health — it is very questionable whether one may skip the meals for this.

Kiddush bimkom se'udah — Kiddush must lead into a meal

From **וְקָרָאתָ לַשַּׁבָּת עֹנֶג** (Yeshayahu 58:13), Chazal learn that where Kiddush is "called", there the meal must be. They should be **closely joined**: Kiddush at 5:30 with the meal at 7:30 is a problem — better to make Kiddush at 7 and eat straight away.

Shul kiddush on Shabbat morning: do you need Kiddush again at home an hour later? You fulfil *bimkom se'udah* at the shul kiddush if you have:

- a **revi'it** of wine (just under 90 ml), **or**
- **mezonot** cake or crackers — a **kezayit** (just under 30 g).

Just a sip of grape juice and then sweets is **not** enough — that Kiddush is void, and you have effectively eaten before Kiddush. Preferably don't do this; but if you see others doing so, there is no need to rebuke them.

Questions from the floor

- **Does the revi'it have to be wine, or any alcoholic drink?** — It has to be **wine**, beyond the Kiddush amount.
- **Can you drink it slowly?** — It must be drunk within a short time (roughly 4–9 minutes; under 10). Drawn out, it loses significance.
- **Francis:** if you won't have a significant amount of food at the shul kiddush, should you partake? — **Better not to**; a couple of pieces of cake or a little wine suffices.
- **Does Shabbat morning need an extra cup?** — No.
- **May one drink before Kiddush on Shabbat morning?** — Preferably not; but one who is very thirsty may drink water (e.g. before Musaf).

Part C — Havdala

What Havdala really is

We think of Havdala as four brachot — in essence it is **two**: **Borei Pri HaGafen** and **Hamavdil bein kodesh lechol**. The **Rambam** holds that just as there is a Torah duty to remember Shabbat as it enters, there is an equal duty to remember it as it **leaves** — Havdala is as important as Kiddush. People careful with Kiddush should be equally careful with Havdala.

Besamim and fire — not the essence

- **Besamim** — to revive the spirit as Shabbat departs; some feel downcast when Shabbat leaves.
- **Fire** — Adam HaRishon first made fire on Motzei Shabbat by striking two stones (Pesachim 54a); we commemorate it.

Neither distinguishes Shabbat from the week, so: **don't delay Havdala** for them, and you are **not obliged to go out and buy** spices or a candle ("you don't have to go to Tesco"). If they are at hand, include them.

Travelling straight after Shabbat

Walking to a bus stop at the end of Shabbat is permitted (it is not preparation for after Shabbat), provided one carries nothing muktseh. But may one make Havdala *before* Shabbat ends?

- The Shulchan Aruch permits Havdala — *without fire* — from **Plag HaMincha** (about 1¼ hours before sunset).
- The poskim advise **against** it, for fear one will then forget it is still Shabbat.
- So: if you can make Havdala the next day (Sunday), wait. Only if you won't be able to make Havdala until Monday or Tuesday (e.g. a 20-hour flight) may you make it early — from Plag, **without fire**, and preferably without besamim.

Going to sleep early in summer

In midsummer Shabbat ends around 10:35 pm (Plag around 8 pm). A tired parent or a teenager wants to sleep at 9:

- **Sephardim** may make up Havdala on **Sunday only** (the "Shabbat as the centre of the week" idea from last week).
- The question of whether early Havdala (from Plag) or Sunday is better is debated; many argue that if one goes **straight to sleep** afterwards, making it early is better — especially for Sephardim.
- **Women are equally obligated in Havdala** — if not on Motzei Shabbat, then at least on Sunday morning. The same for children and teenagers.

Dvar Torah — Parashat Vayera: Pursuing Chesed

The shiur fell on 15 Cheshvan, exactly a month after Sukkot. One who built a sukkah but was rained out for all seven days rightly feels sorry — he wished to do a mitzvah when it was due. But a month later, no one sits wishing he could be in a sukkah, or eat matzah: there is no merit in yearning for a mitzvah out of its time.

Why, then, does Avraham sit at the door of his tent on a scorching day — made hot precisely so that no travellers would trouble him — longing for guests when there is no one in need?

Rav Moshe Feinstein explains that **chesed is different** from every other mitzvah. Other mitzvot we do when the opportunity arises. Chesed must be **pursued** — a person who never does kindness simply because no one around seems to need it is lacking. **צָדֶק צָדֶק תִּרְדֹּף** —

pursue righteousness. Hashem created the world **only to do chesed**, and we are to walk in His ways; so we must seek out opportunities to help, even when none present themselves.

Summary

- **Kiddush** is a Torah mitzvah, said over wine and as early as possible; women are equally obligated and may make Kiddush for men.
- A **cheekful** (~45 ml) must be drunk — ideally by the one making Kiddush, otherwise by anyone; if no one does, repeat it.
- Avoid *kos pagum*: pass the cup, top it up, or pour before drinking.
- Mevushal wine and grape juice are equal; prefer non-mevushal wine if enjoyed; **red over white**.
- No wine: **challah** on Friday night; **chamar medina** on Shabbat morning; Havdala **never on bread**.
- The **three meals** are for enjoyment — with bread; no obligation where they cause real discomfort.
- **Kiddush bimkom se'udah:** follow Kiddush with a meal, a revi'it of wine or a kezayit of cake.
- **Havdala** = Hagafen + Hamavdil; besamim and fire are extras. Make it up by Sunday (Sephardim); early Havdala only in real need.

Coming Up

Shiur 3 — 6 November: The Shabbat Kitchen, Part 1 — Bishul (cooking)

- Reheating food, how to serve food, stirring food on the fire
- Cooking in the sun (*toldot chamah*)
- What really is a *kli sheni* — and how to make a cup of tea

The Rabbi also invited everyone to a kiddush on Shabbat Parashat Chayei Sarah (3 November) to celebrate the birth of his baby daughter.

B'Ezrat Hashem

Watch or listen to this shiur: youtu.be/SyYC7y80wFk · More shiurim: rabbikada.com